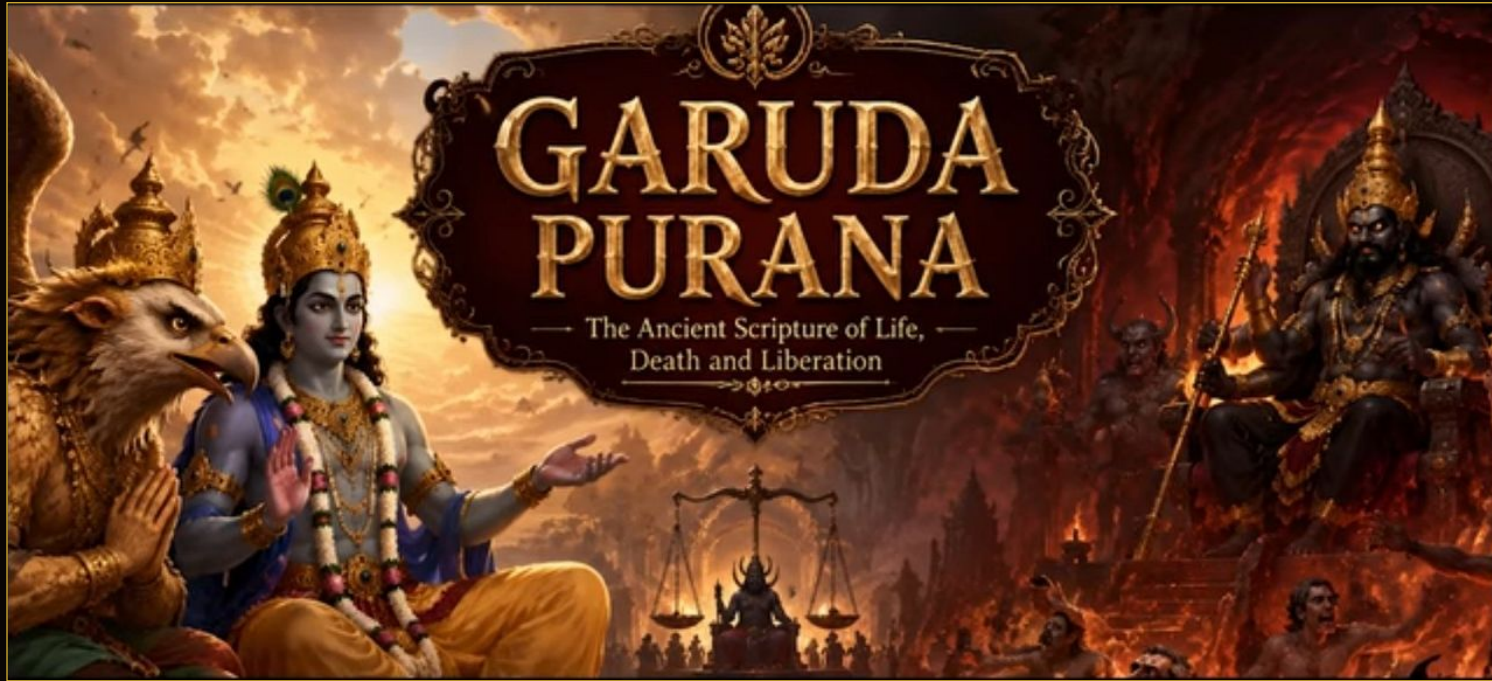




# THE 28 PUNISHMENTS

*as described in the Garuda Purana*

A dramatized educational illustration for reflection - Yama Dharma Terminal

PUNISHMENT 01 / 28

# TAMISRAMA

*For the sin of: Murder*



Bound in total darkness and beaten by Yama's servants.

**Modern parallel:** Homicide is prosecuted as murder or manslaughter in nearly every legal system, typically carrying the most severe penalties available, including life imprisonment or, in some jurisdictions, capital punishment.

# ANDHATHAMISRA

*For the sin of: Deceiving a Spouse*



Stripped of senses in a black pit.

**Modern parallel:** Depending on jurisdiction, marital fraud or bigamy can lead to civil penalties such as annulment, and in some places criminal charges for bigamy or fraud.

# ROURAVA

*For the sin of: Torturing Innocents*



Trapped with venomous serpents.

**Modern parallel:** Assault, torture, or aggravated battery are serious criminal offenses in most countries, often carrying lengthy prison sentences and civil liability for damages.

PUNISHMENT 04 / 28

# MAHAROURAVA

*For the sin of: Extreme Cruelty*



Man-eating beasts tear away flesh.

**Modern parallel:** Domestic cruelty and abuse statutes in many countries impose criminal penalties, protective orders, and mandated counseling on offenders.

PUNISHMENT 05 / 28

# KUMBHIPAKA

*For the sin of: Animal Slaughter*



Submerged in boiling oil.

**Modern parallel:** *Illegal poaching or animal cruelty laws impose fines and imprisonment in most countries, with stricter penalties for endangered species.*

# KALASUTHRAM

*For the sin of: Disrespecting Elders*



Forced to run endlessly on red-hot copper ground.

**Modern parallel:** Elder abuse or neglect can trigger civil liability, mandatory reporting, and in serious cases criminal charges under adult-protective-services laws.

# ASIPATHRAVANA

*For the sin of: Rejecting Dharma / Duty*



Wandering a forest of razor-sharp sword leaves.

**Modern parallel:** Breach of fiduciary or professional duty can result in civil suits, licensing revocation, or criminal negligence charges depending on severity.

PUNISHMENT 08 / 28

# SUKARAMUKHAM

*For the sin of: Tyranny / Abuse of Power*



Mechanically crushed between grinding stones.

**Modern parallel:** Abuse of public office or authority is prosecuted as corruption or misconduct in office, often carrying disqualification from public service and imprisonment.

# ANDHAKUPAM

*For the sin of: Harming Insects Needlessly*



Cast into a dark pit swarming with scorpions.

**Modern parallel:** Reckless environmental harm, such as improper pesticide use, can draw regulatory fines under environmental protection statutes.

# TAPTAMURTI

*For the sin of: Infidelity*



Forced to embrace a white-hot iron figure.

**Modern parallel:** While adultery is rarely criminal today, it commonly carries civil consequences in divorce proceedings, such as affecting alimony or asset division.

# KRIMIBHOJANA

*For the sin of: Hoarding / Wasting Food*



The body is consumed by parasitic worms.

**Modern parallel:** Price gouging or illegal hoarding during shortages is regulated and penalized under consumer protection and emergency-supply laws in many countries.

# SALMALI



PUNISHMENT 13 / 28

# LALABHAKSA

*For the sin of: Betraying Trust*



Forced to ingest toxic fluid.

**Modern parallel:** Breach of contract or fiduciary betrayal can lead to civil lawsuits for damages and, in cases of fraud, criminal prosecution.

# SARAMEYA (SARAMEYADANA)

*For the sin of: Arson*



Set upon by fierce, otherworldly hounds.

**Modern parallel:** Arson is a serious felony in virtually every jurisdiction, often carrying decades of imprisonment, especially where lives are endangered.

# AVICI

*For the sin of: False Witness / Perjury*



Repeatedly cast down from great cliffs.

**Modern parallel:** Perjury and lying under oath are criminal offenses that can result in fines, imprisonment, and the invalidation of legal proceedings.

PUNISHMENT 16 / 28

# AYAHPANA

*For the sin of: Selling Harmful Substances*



Molten metal is poured down the throat.

**Modern parallel:** *Illegal drug trafficking and sale of controlled substances carry some of the harshest criminal penalties worldwide, including long imprisonment.*

# RAKSOBHAKSAM

*For the sin of: Dark Rituals / Human Sacrifice*



Subjected to torment by those once wronged.

**Modern parallel:** Ritual killing or human sacrifice is prosecuted as premeditated murder, one of the most severely punished crimes in any legal system.

PUNISHMENT 18 / 28

# SULAPROTAM

*For the sin of: Ultimate Betrayal*



Impaled upon a great trident.

**Modern parallel:** *Treason or betrayal of a nation's trust is among the most severely punished crimes under most countries' penal codes.*

# KSARAKARDAMA

*For the sin of: Excessive Ego / Arrogance*



Hung upside-down in caustic mud.

**Modern parallel:** While arrogance itself isn't illegal, defamation or slander stemming from prideful conduct can result in civil liability for damages.

# DANDASUKA

*For the sin of: Spreading Social Hatred*



Beset by venomous, serpentine creatures.

**Modern parallel:** *Incitement to hatred or violence is criminalized under hate-speech and public-order laws in many democratic countries.*

# VATARODHAM



# PARYAVARTANA

*For the sin of: Violating Hospitality*



Flesh pecked by iron-beaked birds.

**Modern parallel:** *Abusing a position of trust toward a guest, client, or dependent can trigger civil liability and, in cases of harm, criminal charges.*

PUNISHMENT 23 / 28

# SUCIMUKHAM

*For the sin of: Extreme Greed*



The body is stitched with a thousand needles.

**Modern parallel:** Large-scale financial fraud or embezzlement driven by greed is prosecuted under securities and fraud law, often with lengthy sentences.

# VAJRAKANTAKASALI

*For the sin of: Corruption / Bribery*



Dragged across razor-sharp thorny ground.

**Modern parallel:** Bribery and corruption are criminal offenses under anti-corruption statutes worldwide, typically carrying fines, imprisonment, and career-ending disqualification.

PUNISHMENT 25 / 28

# VAITARANI

*For the sin of: Bribing Officials*



Forced to cross a river of boiling blood and filth.

**Modern parallel:** *Offering bribes to public officials is a criminal act in most legal systems, often prosecuted alongside the official who accepts it.*

# PUYODAKA

*For the sin of: Hypocrisy*



Immersed in a swamp of foul waste.

**Modern parallel:** *Fraudulent misrepresentation, such as false advertising or fake charity solicitation, is regulated and penalized under consumer-fraud statutes.*

# PRANARODHA

*For the sin of: Sport Hunting*



The body is pierced repeatedly with arrows.

**Modern parallel:** *Illegal hunting or poaching of protected species carries fines and imprisonment under wildlife protection laws in most countries.*

# VISASANA

*For the sin of: Exploiting Workers*



Bones are broken with heavy hammers.

**Modern parallel:** Labor exploitation, wage theft, and unsafe working conditions are regulated by labor law, with penalties including fines and business shutdowns.